

Figure 1: Areca GUI (main window)

Now you can easily launch Areca from your console with

- `./areca.sh` for Graphical User Interface
- `./bin/run_tui.sh` for Command Line Interface

Now that you've set up the entire thing, let's understand the basics of Areca—what you'll need to know before getting started with creating your first backup archive.

Basics

Storage modes: Areca follows three different storage modes.

- **Standard** (by default), where a new archive is created on each backup.
- **Delta** (for advanced users), where a new archive is created on each backup, consisting of modified parts of files since the last backup.
- **Image** is a unique backup created, which updates on each backup.

Target: A backup task is termed as 'target' in Areca's terminology. A target defines the following things.

- **Sources:** It defines the files and directories to be stored in the archive at backup.
- **Destination:** It defines the place to store your archives such as file system (external hard drive, USB key, etc) or even your FTP server.
- **Compression and encryption:** You may even define how to store your archives, i.e., compressing into a Zip file if data is large or encrypting the archival data to keep it safe, so that it can be decrypted only by using Areca with the correct decryption key.

Your first backup with Areca

After successfully passing through all the checkpoints, you can now move on to creating your first backup with Areca. First, execute the Areca GUI by running `./areca.sh` from the console. You'll see a window (as shown in Figure 1) open up on your screen. Let's configure a few things.

Set your workspace: The section on the left of the window is your workspace area. The **Select** button here can be used to set your workspace location. This should be the safe location on your computer, where Areca saves its configuration files. You can see the default workspace location here.

Set your target: Now you need to set up your target in order to run your first backup. Go to **Edit > New Target**. You'll have

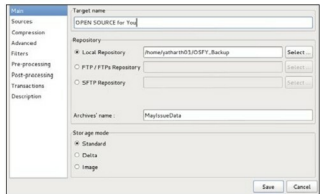


Figure 2: Create a new target (child window)

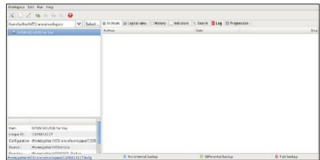


Figure 3: The main window shows your current targets

something like what's shown in Figure 2. Now set your **Target name**, **Local Repository** (this is where your backup archive is saved), **Archive's name** and also **Sources** by switching the tab at the left, and then do any other configuration you'd like to. Next, click on **Save**. Your target has been created. Your main window now looks something like what's shown in Figure 3.

Running your backup: After doing all that is necessary, you can run your first backup. Go to **Run > Backup**. Then select **Use Default Working Directory** to use a temporary sub-directory (created at the same location as the archives). Click on **Start Backup**. Great, so you have now created your first backup.

Recovery: You have a backup archive of your data now. This may be used at any time to recover your lost data. Just select your target from the workspace on the left and right click on the archive on the right section, which you wish to use to recover your data. Click **Recover**, choose the location, and click **OK**.

At this stage, you can easily create backups using the Areca GUI. However, you can further learn to configure your backups at <http://areca-backup.org/tutorial.php>.

Using the command line interface

You just used the Areca GUI to create a backup and recover your data again. Although the GUI is the preferred option, you may use the CLI, too, for the same purpose. This may seem good to those comfortable with the console. However, this is also useful in the case of scheduled backups.

To run it, just go to the Areca directory and follow up with the general syntax below: